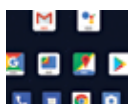




Corsair acquires Origin PC

Corsair has bought up Origin PC, a US-based boutique gaming rig builder, expect cool rigs. <https://digit.in/aug19-51>



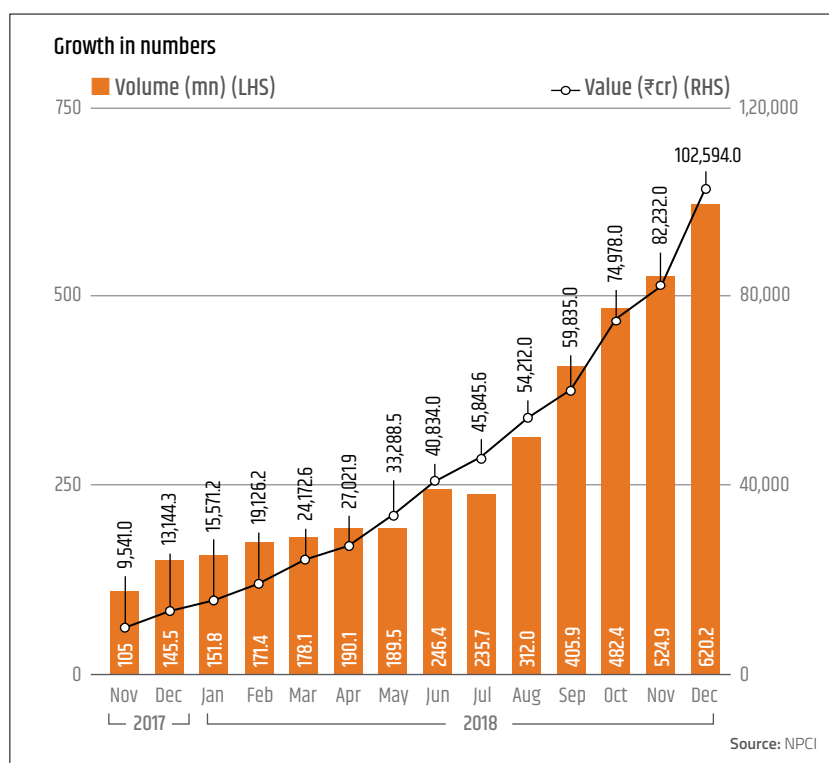
Google Go to integrate new apps

New changes coming to Google Go will add direct voice search, Assistant Go and Google Lens to the app. <https://digit.in/aug19-52>

involved in online banking. With UPI, sending and receiving money solely relies on a unique identifier known as UPI ID or a virtual address. Traditional services like NEFT or RTGS, which are used to transact money online, require a host of details about the receiver's bank account before you can start transferring or receiving funds. Setting up a payee account (someone you want to send money to) can be a tedious process, since you not only have to enter all the bank account details of the receiver but would also have to wait for a certain time period (different for different banks) for the banks to authenticate the payee, known as the 'cooldown period'. UPI is available 24 hours of the day, 7 days of the week, so you can transact money digitally at any time of the day. Basically, if you have a bank account, debit card and phone number, you can have a UPI ID. Same goes with the person you want to send money to. Gone are the days of typing in the bank account number, IMPS code, and many such details to complete digital transactions.

UPI leverages the growing presence of mobile phones, especially considering the fact that India is currently the second-largest consumer of smart-phones in the world. It uses the devices as virtual addresses instead of actual physical cards (debit or credit), therefore reducing cost and acquiring and issuing infrastructure as well. UPI is often described with an array of adjectives which are all mostly true, some being - cheap, secure, reliable, mobile-first, open-source, interoperable (between two different banks), instantaneous and more. They certainly have an edge over pre-paid wallets such as PayTm, ICICI Pockets and more, many of which have a limit to the number of transactions or can't do any transactions at all, without completing KYC (Know Your Customer), another time-consuming process. UPI-enabled platforms, on the other hand, can transfer up to a lakh rupees per day or up to 10 UPI transactions per day (these figures can be slightly different based on your bank and UPI app).

Additionally, UPI is a real-time payment system, which is basically



UPI's value grew by 700% in 2018

IMPS (Immediate Payment Service) on steroids. It is designed to enable peer-to-peer inter-bank transactions within a couple of clicks and of course, entering your UPI PIN. Apps such as GPay, BHIM and PhonePe now allow users to pay bills and recharge their prepaid numbers. Additionally, you can also pay for movie tickets on apps such as Book My Show and pay for your late-night (or any time of the day) Swiggy or Zomato food orders by using UPI.

UNPRECEDENTED GROWTH

One of the biggest contributors to UPI's growth is the scratchcard system implemented by Google Pay (Tez). Peer-to-peer back and forth transactions in hope to win a cashback amount are aplenty. Whatever the cause may be, the UPI initiative has indeed proved successful in majorly transforming India into a less cash-reliant economy. It is becoming one of the fastest modes to bring about digital finance inclusion in India owing to its mobile-first design and approach. UPI has actually managed to steal away market share from net banking instead of just being a mobile wallet killer. What

started out as a P2P payment mode in 2017, has now evolved to becoming a preferred merchant payment platform (P2M). UPI 2.0 brought in the feature of overdraft facility and essentially bridged the gap between merchants and customers, which, in the end, made UPI a more holistic digital payment solution. Apart from overdraft facility, UPI 2.0 also brought in features such as One Time Mandate, Invoice in the Inbox, Signed Intent and QR. Banks and Fintechs now have a huge canvas to collaborate and deliver value to their customers through UPI 2.0. UPI has emerged as a major payment option for Indians with transactions worth Rs 8.70 lakh crore in 2018-2019, which is a recorded 695 per cent growth over the UPI transactions in 2017-2018 (Rs 1.09 lakh crore). Experts predict the volume of digital mobile payments to increase tenfold by 2020 and believe that 50 per cent of internet users in India will begin to use digital payments by 2020 as well. India is still in the nascent stage of this digitisation process in the financial sector, however, the scale-up over the past few years is impressive nonetheless.